Etsy

Presented by Meng Yuan Aug 5th, 2026

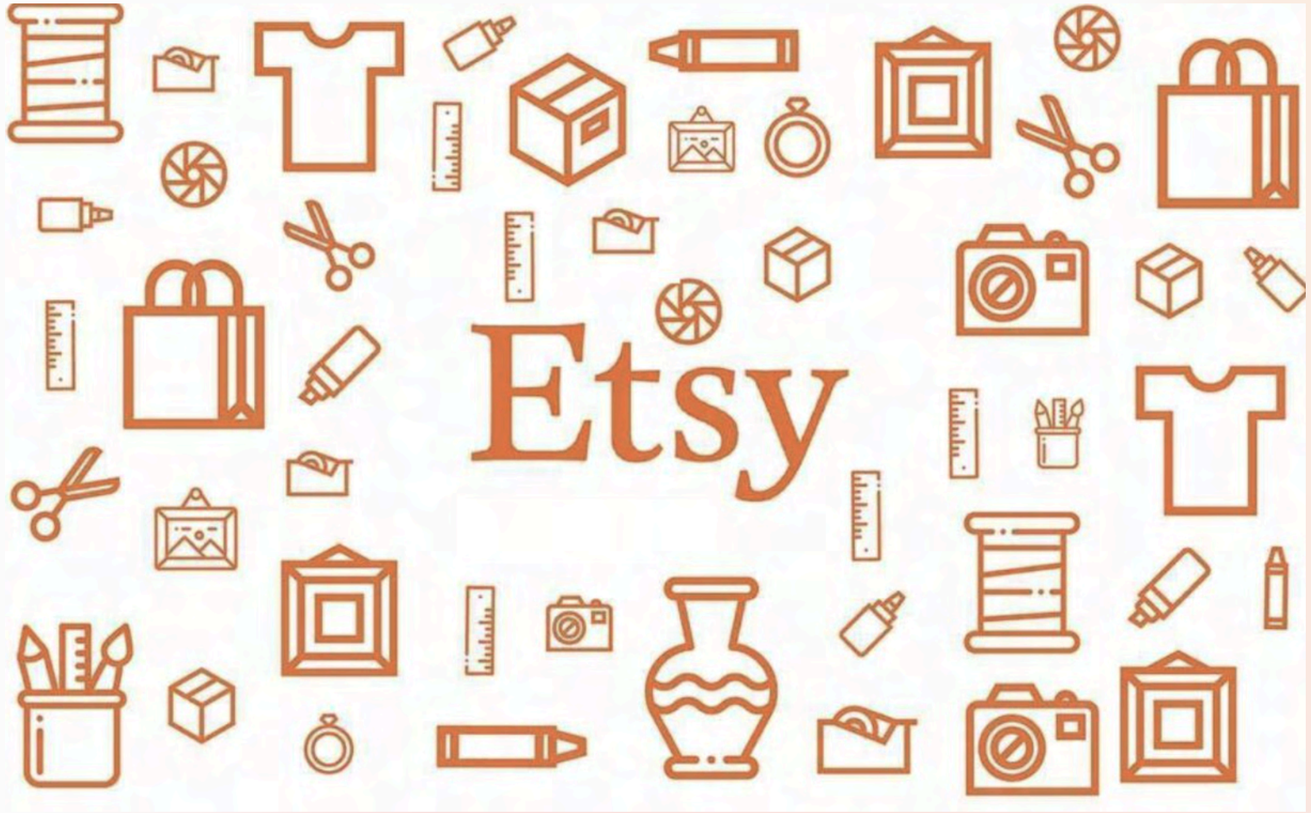
# Target Audience Pitch

Johns Hopkins University
AS.480.668.80.SU26 Understanding Audiences and Markets

Etsy

# Our Client

Etsy is an online marketplace that connects independent sellers with buyers around the world, with a strong focus on handmade, vintage, and custom products. Unlike general marketplaces such as Amazon, Etsy was created to give artists, crafters, and small brands a place to sell unique, creative items. The categories it covers include **Toys, Home & Living, Gifts, Accessories, and so on.**



Etsy

# Problems

- **The Core Issue**

Approximately half of Etsy's active buyers make only one purchase per year. Etsy has not yet become part of consumers' ***everyday shopping habits.***

- **Why Home & Living?**

Home & Living is one of Etsy's ***largest*** categories and showed year-over-year growth in Q4 2025.  It is an appropriate testing ground for a repeat-purchase driver strategy.

- **Challenge**

Within the Home & Living category, identify the consumer segment most likely to form repeat purchase behavior.

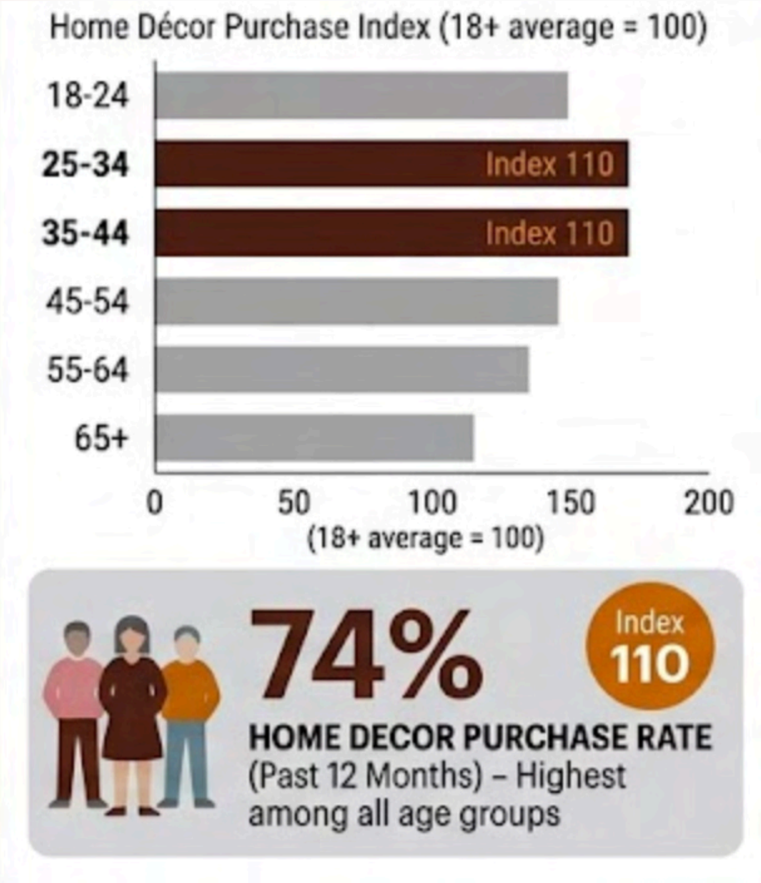
## How can Etsy Turn "Occasional Shoppers" into "Habitual Repeat Buyers"?

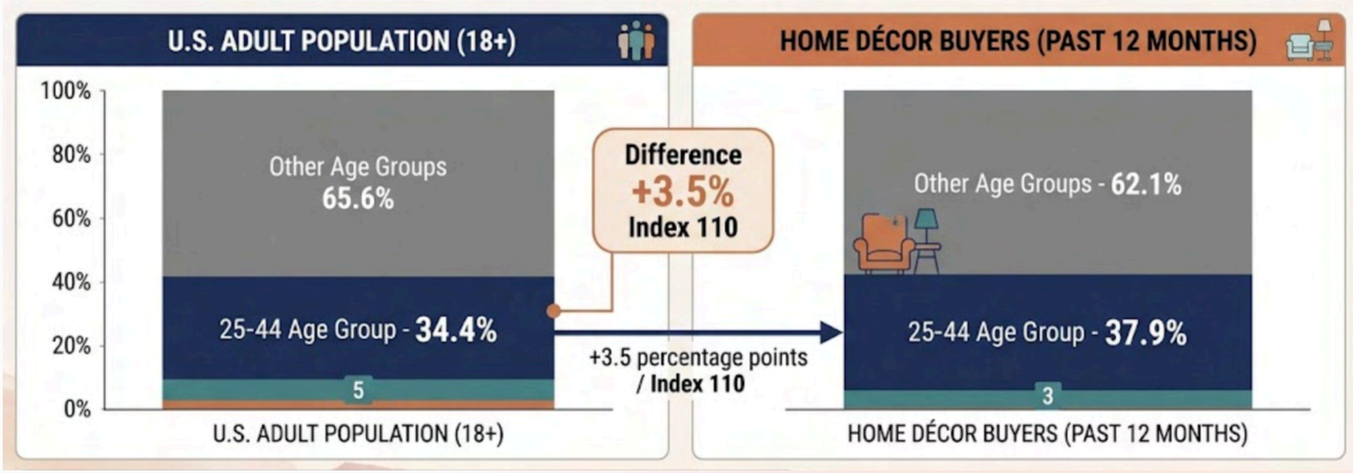



> *"We believe Etsy should be able to get consumers to think of us more often for more purchase occasions."* — **Etsy 2025 Annual Report**

# Target Audience & Segment

**The Broad Segment:**
**U.S. internet users aged 25–44 who have purchased home décor or furniture items in the past 12 months.**




Index **131** on Etsy.com (Past 6 Months)

Index **136** for Arts & Crafts Purchases

Index **154** for Active Instagram Usage

# “The Sensory Curator”

**The Focused Segment：“The Sensory Curator”**

**Home shoppers aged 25–44 who treat décor as a tool for mood, atmosphere, and sensory identity, not just visual aesthetics. They buy based on how a space feels (scent, texture, lighting, seasonal mood) .**

1. **Age 25–44 Home Shoppers**
   34.4% of U.S. adults | Index 110 for home décor
2. **Metropolitan and Micropolitan Residents**
   Population coverage of 95%+ in major metro areas | Higher shopping frequency and spending than suburban and rural areas
3. **High-Frequency Category Buyers**
   Candles/Fragrance + Seasonal Décor = The only two categories with sustained growth
4. **Life Transition / Recent Movers**
   Ages 25–34: 62.7% homeowners + 87% renters = Moved in after 2020
5. **Style-Flexible Explorers**
   78% open to exploring different styles | 75% have a clear style preference
6. **Digital-First Shoppers**
   60% get inspiration online | Instagram Index 154 | Pinterest
7. **Brand-Agnostic**
   55% say brand “not important” | Uniqueness matters more than labels

**THE SENSORY CURATOR**

Style-flexible, digitally inspired home shoppers who curate mood and meaning in every detail of their home.



## DEMOGRAPHICS

- **Age:** 25–44 (core 25–34)
- **Geography:** Urban Areas
- **Housing:** Mixed 25–34: 66% rent 35–44: 53% own
- **Recent Move:** 62–87% moved in since 2020
- **Household:** 2.5 avg 46.7% married couples 36% nonfamily



## BEHAVIORS

- **Buys:** Candles + Seasonal Décor
- **Shops:** Etsy Index 131 Arts & Crafts 136
- **Inspired by:** Instagram Index 154 Pinterest
- **Cadence:** High-frequency, low-commitment items
- **Purchase Trigger:** Seasonal change, Post-move, “Treat self”



## VALUES

- **Style-flexible:** 78% open to explore
- **Brand-agnostic:** 55% “not important”
- **Value-conscious:** 70% cautious on price 68% wait for sales
- **Emotion-driven:** “Home = mood, not investment”
- **Time-scarce:** Need quick, easy solutions




Sources: MRI-Simmons 2023 Fall; Mintel, Dec 2025; ACS 2024 1-Year Estimates

# Storytelling Strategy

## From Pain Points and Value to Storytelling

## Messaging

1. Rental limits + Sanctuary →“Make It Yours, No Permission Needed"/”Your space, Your rules.”
2. Time scarcity + Self-expression→"Instant Atmosphere, Zero Effort"
3. Spending guilt + Value →"Little Luxuries, Fully Justified"

# THE SENSORY CURATOR

*“I don’t just decorate — I create a mood.”*






## *Emma Carter* (28)

- **Occupation:** Marketing Manager
- **Location:** Austin, TX (Metropolitan Area)
- **Housing:** Renter (moved in 14 months ago)
- **Household:** Lives with partner, no kids
- **Space:** 1-bedroom apartment, ~750 sq ft
- **Lifestyle:** Busy, stylish, values experiences, digitally connected

*“Home is where I can recharge, express myself, and create the mood I want to live in.”*

### DAILY BEHAVIORS & ROUTINES

**MORNING SCROLL**
Instagram + Pinterest over coffee — saving ideas for “how I want my space to feel”

**_WORKDAY**
Hybrid (3 days in office, 2 from home). On WFH days, she lights a candle to signal “work mode” vs. “relax mode”

**EVENING WIND-DOWN**
Winds down with a candle, a throw blanket, and her phone — often browsing Etsy for “small upgrades”

**WEEKEND REFRESH**
Visits local markets or browses Etsy for seasonal swaps — fall is her favorite season to refresh

**HOSTING MOMENTS**
“Quick vibe check” before friends come over — new candle, rearranges pillows, fresh flowers

**PURCHASE RHYTHM**
Small items every 4–6 weeks, usually under $50. Waits for sales but impulse-buys if it “feels right.”

### VALUES (What matters to her)

**SANCTUARY**
Home is where she decompresses, recharges, and feels in control.

**SELF-EXPRESSION**
Has taste but isn’t rigid — enjoys mixing things up and exploring different styles.

**AUTHENTICITY**
Uniqueness matters more than logos. She wants pieces that feel personal, not mass-produced.

**VALUE**
Price-conscious, not price-averse. Will pay for things that genuinely improve daily life.

**EASE**
No time for complicated projects. Wants instant, visible impact with zero effort.

**TOGETHERNESS**
Home is also about shared rituals with her partner — cozy nights, hosting friends.

### PAIN POINTS

**RENTAL LIMITS**
“I can’t paint, I can’t change the fixtures, but I still want it to feel like mine.”

**DECISION FATIGUE**
“I love discovering new styles, but there are TOO MANY options. I scroll for hours and still can’t decide.”

**SPENDING GUILT**
“I want to treat myself, but I’m watching my spending. I need to feel like it’s ‘worth it.”

**TIME SCARCITY**
“Between work, life, and everything else, I don’t have energy for big projects.”

**STYLE INSECURITY**
“I know what I like, but I don’t know how to pull it all together without looking like a catalog.”

# Storytelling Strategies and Tactics

## 「Instant Atmosphere, Zero Effort」

- **Channel Selection: Instagram Reels / TikTok**

*Launch a 「15-Minute Refresh」 series:*

*- Fixed camera angle, 15-second countdown overlay*

*- Swap only: 1 candle + 1 throw blanket + 1 bunch of flowers*

*- Caption: "No drill. No paint. Just vibe."*

- **Channel Selection: Etsy Website**

*- Add a 「15-Minute Fix」 badge to relevant products (candles, throws, vases).*

*- Place a "Before vs After (15 min)" side-by-side image at the top of the product detail page, clearly labeling exactly what was swapped.*






# Storytelling Strategies and Tactics

## 「Make It Yours, No Permission Needed」

- **Channel Selection: Etsy Website**

*3-step install image*

*- ① Open box → ② Hang with command hooks (no tools visible) → ③ Finished cozy room*

*- Labels: "1. Open · 2. Hang (no tools) · 3. Enjoy"*




- **Channel Selection: Pinterest**

*Create a dedicated board*

*- Board name: "Renter-Friendly Decor Ideas"*

*- Board description: "No nails. No paint. No problem. All the rental-friendly decor inspo you need."*

*- Post 1–2 Pins daily*



# Storytelling Strategies and Tactics

## 「Little Luxuries, Fully Justified」

- **Channel Selection:** Instagram Story

*- Run a poll: "Which little luxury are you taking home tonight?"*

*- Options A / B / C (all $25 items).*

*- After voting, link directly to the winning product with the result copy: "You chose self-care. We approve."*

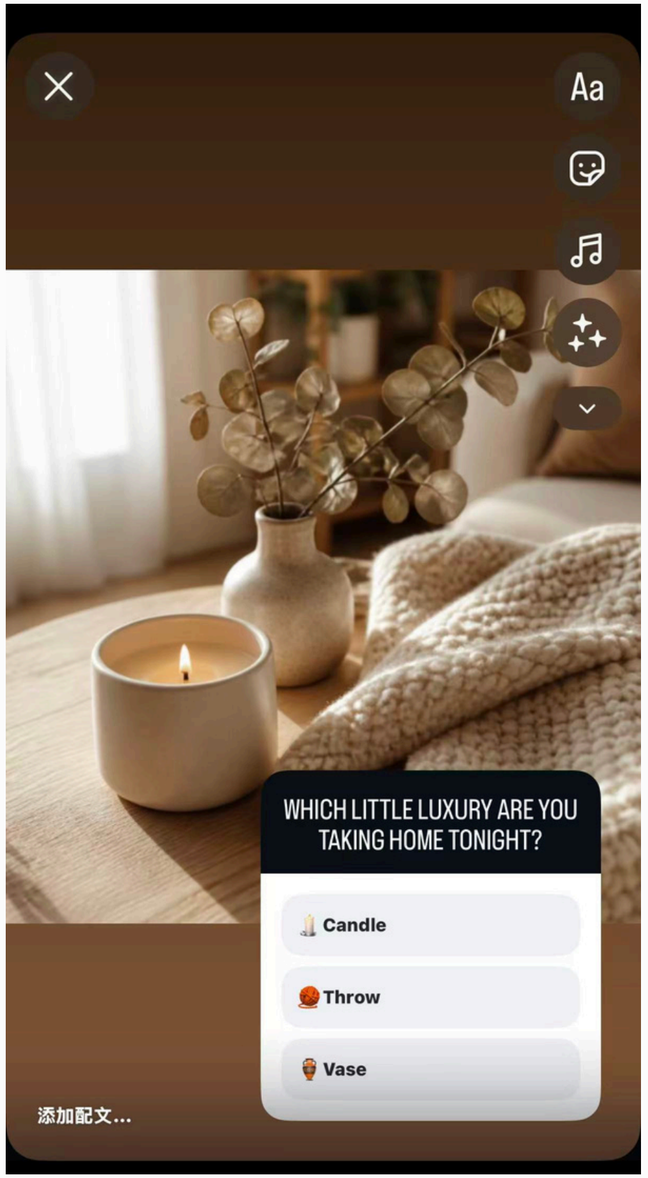
- **Channel Selection: Etsy Website Promotion**

*Create 「The Reset Trio」:*

*- 1 scent item + 1 tactile object (small cushion / coaster set) + 1 visual item (mini art print / bud vase)*

*- Priced at $49 (effectively 3 little luxuries)*

*- Copy: "A gift from you, to you. No occasion needed."*



# So What?

## How will our specific stories solve the business problem?




| Buyer Type | Etsy's Definition |
|---|---|
| **Active Buyer** | At least 1 purchase in the last 12 months |
| **Repeat Buyer** | More than 1 purchase in the last 12 months |
| **Habitual Buyer** | 6+ purchase days + $200+ spend in the last 12 months |

- **Etsy's Problem:**

Active buyers ↓ 3.4%. Habitual buyers ↓ 9%. Repeat buyers ↓ 4%. ~50% of buyers purchase once per year.

- **Etsy's Goal:**

"Get consumers to think of us more often for more purchase occasions."

- **The Expected Result:**

One-time buyers become repeat buyers. Repeat buyers become habitual buyers. Etsy's declining buyer metrics reverse — without spending on acquisition.

# By telling stories, we're trying to build a conversion path.

| From → To | What The Strategy Does | Through What Messages? |
|---|---|---|
| **Focused Audience → Active Buyer** | Reactivates lapsed or one-time Etsy shoppers by validating their life stage — renting, moving, no permission needed | "Make It Yours — No Permission Needed" |
| **Active Buyer → Repeat Buyer** | Shows up at life moments: post-move, hosting, seasonal changes. Gives them reasons to return beyond the first purchase. | "Instant Atmosphere" |
| **Repeat Buyer → Habitual Buyer** | Turns Etsy into a routine. Self-gifting as emotional maintenance. Visual discovery on Instagram + Pinterest drives impulse. Email brings them back season after season. | "Little Luxuries" |

# So What?

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# Thank You